



“All group companies are working on their own transition to sustainable pathways based on their sector’s uniqueness, geography and value chain approach”

DEEKSHA VATS

GROUP CHIEF SUSTAINABILITY OFFICER,
ADITYA BIRLA GROUP



“At present, 44% of our generation comes from clean and green sources. By 2030, we aim to reach 70%, with a goal of transitioning to a 100% clean portfolio by 2045”

PRAVEER SINHA

CEO & MD, TATA POWER

lar, wind and hybrid projects will be strategically supported by energy storage systems and pumped hydro projects for grid flexibility.

THE FUNDING

The futuristic technologies for shifting to a low carbon ecosystem requires huge investments amid uncertainty around energy and battery solutions. The key is to strike a balance between energy security, sustainability and socio-economic development in a developing country like India, aspiring to become developed by 2047. “Financial sustainability is fundamental to sustainability. If you do not make money, you wouldn’t be in business,” says Aditya Birla Group’s Vats. The group has started mapping its value chain, initially piloting with three businesses, and has onboarded critical suppliers on a digital platform to understand the challenges in becoming sustainable and how they can be resolved.

“We got all heads of sustainability and procurement together to ask, ‘what are the issues that you’re facing?’ There is a lot of cohesive working across departments—procurement, marketing, research & development and sustainability—so that sustainability is everybody’s baby. The respective teams need to understand why we are mainstreaming sustainability,” says Vats.

This means turning challenges into opportunities. External stakeholder expectations, interest from investors and rise of climate-con-

scious consumers are making companies walk the extra mile to green their operations. Tata Power has earmarked ₹25,000 crore in capital expenditure in FY26, with the lion’s share of 60% directed towards renewable energy generation, including solar, wind and hybrid projects that are central to the company’s net-zero ambitions. “A sustainable future hinges on robust green financing to drive large-scale infrastructure and innovation. Tata Power has signed an MoU with the Asian Development Bank to explore \$4.25 billion funding for clean energy projects, demonstrating how strategic financing can fast-track the energy transition. We are also actively partnering with government and academia to further R&D in efficient technologies that can fast-track the pace of the transition,” says Sinha. Apart from finance, other industry-specific challenges need to be addressed too. He says India’s energy transition can be accelerated by overcoming the challenges of timely execution of extensive projects, which remains a key hurdle, particularly given the complexities associated with land acquisition, regulatory clearances and local stakeholder engagement. “In the face of global tariffs and economic volatility, supply chain—especially in the sourcing of solar modules, batteries, and other critical components—operational risks and cost pressures are present as well,” he adds.

According to Mody, with growing pressure from investors, regulators and customers to achieve sustainability targets, companies are coming around to a uniform agenda of acting on decarbonisation and better resource utilisation. “More pressure for transparency has resulted in initiatives for streamlining primary data collection and validation before reporting. Robust systems and processes are being put in place to ensure that accurate, real and timely data is collated,” she says. It’s a long journey with a common goal to become carbon neutral while remaining profitable. **BT**

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